

Calculus I

Homework

Limits involving infinity

1. Evaluate the difference quotient and simplify your answer.

(a) $\frac{f(2+h) - f(2)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^2 - x - 1$.

ANSWER: $h + 3$

(b) $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^2$.

ANSWER: $h + 2a$

(c) $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^3$.

ANSWER: $h^2 + 3a^2 + 3ah$

(d) $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^4$.

ANSWER: $6a^3h + 4a^2h^2 + 3ah^3 + h^4$

(e) $\frac{f(x) - f(a)}{x - a}$, where $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$.

ANSWER: $-\frac{1}{x^2}$

(f) $\frac{f(x) - f(1)}{x - 1}$, where $f(x) = \frac{x-1}{x+1}$.

ANSWER: $\frac{x}{1+x}$

2. Write down a formula for a function whose graphs is given below. The graphs are up to scale. Please note that there is more than one way to write down a correct answer.

$$\text{answer: } y = \begin{cases} -\frac{3}{2}x - 12 & \text{if } 2 \leq x < 3 \\ -\frac{3}{2}x - \frac{1}{2} & \text{if } 0 < x \leq 2 \end{cases}$$

$$\text{answer: } y = \begin{cases} -\frac{3}{2}x + 3 & \text{if } 0 < x \leq 2 \\ -\frac{3}{2}x - \frac{1}{2} & \text{if } 2 < x \leq 3 \end{cases}$$

(b)

(d)

$$\text{answer: } y = \begin{cases} -3x - 4 & \text{if } -2 \leq x < -1 \\ -2x + 1 & \text{if } -1 \leq x < 0 \\ 3x - 4 & \text{if } 0 \leq x < 1 \\ -2x + 1 & \text{if } 1 \leq x < 2 \\ 3x - 4 & \text{if } 2 \leq x < 3 \end{cases}$$

$$\text{answer: } y = \begin{cases} -\frac{3}{2}x + \frac{5}{2} & \text{if } -3 \leq x < -1 \\ -4x + 6 & \text{if } -1 < x \leq 2 \end{cases}$$

(c)

3. Write down formulas for function whose graphs are as follows. The graphs are up to scale. All arcs are parts of circles.

(a)

4. Evaluate the difference quotient and simplify your answer.

(a) $\frac{f(2+h) - f(2)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^2 - x - 1$.

(d) $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^4$.

(b) $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^2$.

(e) $\frac{f(x) - f(a)}{x - a}$, where $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$.

(c) $\frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$, where $f(x) = x^3$.

(f) $\frac{f(x) - f(1)}{x - 1}$, where $f(x) = \frac{x-1}{x+1}$.

5. Find the implied domain of the function.

(a) $f(x) = \frac{x+4}{x^2-4}$.

(e) $h(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt[6]{x^2-7x}}$.

(b) $f(x) = \frac{2x^3-5}{x^2+5x+6}$.

(f) $f(u) = \frac{u+1}{1+\frac{1}{u+1}}$.

(c) $f(t) = \sqrt[3]{3t-1}$.

(g) $F(x) = \sqrt{10-\sqrt{x}}$.

(d) $g(t) = \sqrt{5-t} - \sqrt{1+t}$.

6. Find the implied domain of the function.

(a) $f(x) = \frac{x+4}{x^2-4}$.

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(f) $f(u) = \frac{u+1}{1+\frac{1}{u+1}}$.

(c) $f(t) = \sqrt[3]{3t-1}$.

(g) $F(x) = \sqrt{10-\sqrt{x}}$.

(d) $g(t) = \sqrt{5-t} - \sqrt{1+t}$.

7. Compute the composite functions $(f \circ g)(x)$, $(g \circ f)(x)$. Simplify your answer to a single fraction. Find the domain of the composite function.

(a) $f(x) = \frac{x+2}{x-2}$, $g(x) = \frac{x-1}{x+2}$.

(b) $f(x) = \frac{x+1}{3x-2}$, $g(x) = \frac{x-2}{x-1}$.

$$\text{answer: } (f \circ g)(x) = \frac{x-5}{3x-2}, \quad (g \circ f)(x) = \frac{x-5}{3x-2}$$

$$\text{answer: } (f \circ g)(x) = \frac{x-5}{3x-2}, \quad (g \circ f)(x) = \frac{x-5}{3x-2}$$

$$(c) f(x) = \frac{2x+1}{3x-1}, g(x) = \frac{x-2}{2x-1}.$$

$$(d) f(x) = \frac{x+1}{x-2}, g(x) = \frac{x+2}{2x-1}.$$

$$(e) f(x) = \frac{5x+1}{4x-1}, g(x) = \frac{4x-1}{3x+1}.$$

$$(f) f(x) = \frac{3x-5}{x-2}, g(x) = \frac{x-2}{x-4}.$$

$$(g) f(x) = \frac{x-3}{x+2}, g(y) = \frac{y+3}{y-4}.$$

$$\text{ANSWER: } \begin{aligned} (f \circ g)(x) &= \frac{-5+4x}{-5+4x} = 1 \\ (f \circ f)(x) &= \frac{x+6}{x-3} \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{ANSWER: } \begin{aligned} (f \circ g)(x) &= \frac{1+3x}{1+3x} = 1 \\ (g \circ f)(x) &= \frac{x+4}{x-4} \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{ANSWER: } \begin{aligned} (f \circ g)(x) &= \frac{-4+23x}{-4+23x} = 1 \\ (f \circ f)(x) &= \frac{2+19x}{2+19x} = 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{ANSWER: } \begin{aligned} (f \circ g)(x) &= \frac{-2x+14}{-2x+14} = 1 \\ (g \circ f)(x) &= \frac{-x+6}{-x+6} = 1 \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{ANSWER: } \begin{aligned} (f \circ g)(x) &= \frac{-2x+15}{-2x+15} = 1 \\ (f \circ f)(x) &= \frac{4x+3}{4x+3} = 1 \end{aligned}$$

8. Find the functions $f \circ g$, $g \circ f$, $f \circ f$ and $g \circ g$ and their implied domains. The answer key has not been proofread, use with caution.

$$(a) f(x) = x^2 + 1, g(x) = x + 1.$$

$$(b) f(x) = \sqrt{x+1}, g(x) = x + 1.$$

$$(c) f(x) = 2x, g(x) = \tan x.$$

In this subproblem, you are not required to find the domain.

$$(d) f(x) = \frac{x+1}{x-1}, g(x) = \frac{x-1}{x+1}.$$

$$\text{ANSWER: } \begin{aligned} \text{Domain of } f \circ g \text{ is } x > -2. \text{ Domain of } g \circ f \text{ is } x \geq -1. \text{ Domain of } f \circ f \text{ is all reals } (x \in \mathbb{R}). \\ \text{Domain of } g \circ g \text{ is } x \neq \frac{\pi}{2} \text{ and } x \neq \frac{3\pi}{2} \text{ for all } k \in \mathbb{Z}. \end{aligned}$$

9. Convert from degrees to radians.

$$(a) 15^\circ.$$

$$(h) 120^\circ.$$

$$(n) 305^\circ.$$

$$(b) 30^\circ.$$

$$(i) 135^\circ.$$

$$(o) 360^\circ.$$

$$(c) 36^\circ.$$

$$(j) 150^\circ.$$

$$(p) 405^\circ.$$

$$(d) 45^\circ.$$

$$(k) 180^\circ.$$

$$(q) 1200^\circ.$$

$$(e) 60^\circ.$$

$$(l) 225^\circ.$$

$$(r) -900^\circ.$$

$$(f) 75^\circ.$$

$$(m) 270^\circ.$$

$$(s) -2014^\circ.$$

$$(g) 90^\circ.$$

10. Convert from radians to degrees. The answer key has not been proofread, use with caution.

$$(a) 4\pi.$$

$$(c) \frac{7}{12}\pi.$$

$$(e) -\frac{3}{8}\pi.$$

$$(b) -\frac{7}{6}\pi.$$

$$(d) \frac{4}{3}\pi.$$

$$(f) 2014\pi.$$

(g) 5.

(h) -2014.

$$\frac{1}{1000} \approx \frac{1}{1000}$$

$$\frac{1}{1000} \approx \frac{1}{1000}$$

11. Prove the trigonometry identities.

(a) $\sin \theta \cot \theta = \cos \theta$.

(b) $(\sin \theta + \cos \theta)^2 = 1 + \sin(2\theta)$.

(c) $\sec \theta - \cos \theta = \tan \theta \sin \theta$.

(d) $\tan^2 \theta - \sin^2 \theta = \tan^2 \theta \sin^2 \theta$.

(e) $\cot^2 \theta + \sec^2 \theta = \tan^2 \theta + \csc^2 \theta$.

(f) $2 \csc(2\theta) = \sec \theta \csc \theta$.

(g) $\tan(2\theta) = \frac{2 \tan \theta}{1 - \tan^2 \theta}$.

(h) $\frac{1}{1 - \sin \theta} + \frac{1}{1 + \sin \theta} = 2 \sec^2 \theta$.

(i) $\tan \alpha + \tan \beta = \frac{\sin(\alpha + \beta)}{\cos \alpha \cos \beta}$.

(j) $\tan(\alpha + \beta) = \frac{\tan \alpha + \tan \beta}{1 - \tan \alpha \tan \beta}$.

(k) $\sin(3\theta) + \sin \theta = 2 \sin(2\theta) \cos \theta$.

(l) $\cos(3\theta) = 4 \cos^3 \theta - 3 \cos \theta$.

(m) $1 + \tan^2 \theta = \sec^2 \theta$.

(n) $1 + \csc^2 \theta = \cot^2 \theta$.

(o) $2 \cos^2(2x) = 2 \sin^4 \theta + 2 \cos^4 \theta - \sin^2(2\theta)$.

(p) $\frac{1 + \tan(\frac{\theta}{2})}{1 - \tan(\frac{\theta}{2})} = \tan \theta + \sec \theta$.

12. Find all values of x in the interval $[0, 2\pi]$ that satisfy the equation.

(a) $2 \cos x - 1 = 0$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

(b) $\sin(2x) = \cos x$.

$$\frac{9}{x} = x \text{ or } \frac{9}{x} = x$$

(c) $\sqrt{3} \sin x = \sin(2x)$.

$$\frac{9}{x} = x \text{ or } \frac{9}{x} = x$$

(d) $2 \sin^2 x = 1$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

(e) $2 + \cos(2x) = 3 \cos x$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

(f) $2 \cos x + \sin(2x) = 0$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

(g) $2 \cos^2 x - (1 + \sqrt{2}) \cos x + \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} = 0$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

(h) $|\tan x| = 1$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

(i) $3 \cot^2 x = 1$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

(j) $\sin x = \tan x$.

$$\frac{x}{2} = x \text{ or } \frac{x}{2} = x$$

Solution. 12.g Set $\cos x = u$. Then

$$2 \cos^2 x - (1 + \sqrt{2}) \cos x + \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} = 0$$

becomes

$$2u^2 - (1 + \sqrt{2})u + \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} = 0.$$

This is a quadratic equation in u and therefore has solutions

$$\begin{aligned} u_1, u_2 &= \frac{1 + \sqrt{2} \pm \sqrt{(1 + \sqrt{2})^2 - 4\sqrt{2}}}{2} \\ &= \frac{1 + \sqrt{2} \pm \sqrt{1 - 2\sqrt{2} + 2}}{2} \\ &= \frac{1 + \sqrt{2} \pm \sqrt{(1 - \sqrt{2})^2}}{2} \\ &= \frac{1 + \sqrt{2} \pm (1 - \sqrt{2})}{2} = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2} & \text{or} \\ \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

Therefore $u = \cos x = \frac{1}{2}$ or $u = \cos x = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$, and, as x is in the interval $[0, 2\pi]$, we get $x = \frac{\pi}{3}, \frac{5\pi}{3}$ (for $\cos x = \frac{1}{2}$) or $x = \frac{\pi}{4}, \frac{7\pi}{4}$ (for $\cos x = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$).

13. Evaluate the limits. Justify your computations.

$$(a) \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} 2x^2 - 3x - 6.$$

$$(b) \lim_{x \rightarrow -1} \frac{x^4 - x}{x^2 + 2x + 3}.$$

$$(c) \lim_{x \rightarrow -1} \frac{1}{x^2 - 3x + 2}.$$

$$(d) \lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \sqrt{x^4 + 16}.$$

$$(e) \lim_{x \rightarrow 8} (1 + \sqrt[3]{x})(2 - x).$$

14. Evaluate the limit if it exists.

$$(a) \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \frac{x^2 - 5x + 6}{x - 2}.$$

$$(b) \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{x^2 - 3x}{x^2 - 2x - 3}.$$

$$(c) \lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \frac{2x^2 + x - 6}{x^2 - 4}$$

$$(d) \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \frac{x^2 - 5x - 6}{x - 2}.$$

$$(e) \lim_{x \rightarrow -1} \frac{x^2 - 3x}{x^2 - 2x - 3}.$$

$$(f) \lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \frac{x^2 - 4}{2x^2 + 5x + 2}.$$

$$(g) \lim_{x \rightarrow -1} \frac{2x^2 + 3x + 1}{3x^2 - 2x - 5}.$$

$$(h) \lim_{x \rightarrow -4} \frac{x^2 + 7x + 12}{x^2 + 6x + 8}.$$

$$(i) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{(-3 + h)^2 - 9}{h}.$$

$$(j) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{(-2 + h)^3 + 8}{h}.$$

$$(k) \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} \frac{x + 3}{x^3 + 27}.$$

$$(l) \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^4 - 1}{x^3 - 1}.$$

$$(m) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{4 + h} - 2}{h}.$$

$$(n) \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{\sqrt{5x + 1} - 4}{x - 3}.$$

$$(o) \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} \frac{\sqrt{x^2 + 16} - 5}{x + 3}.$$

$$(p) \lim_{x \rightarrow -3} \frac{\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{x}}{3 + x}.$$

$$(q) \lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \frac{x^2 + 4x + 4}{x^4 - 16}.$$

$$(r) \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{1 + x} - \sqrt{1 - x}}{x}.$$

$$(s) \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \left(\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{x^2 + x} \right).$$

$$(t) \lim_{x \rightarrow 9} \frac{3 - \sqrt{x}}{9x - x^2}.$$

$$(u) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{(2 + h)^{-1} - 2^{-1}}{h}.$$

$$(v) \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \left(\frac{1}{x\sqrt{1 + x}} - \frac{1}{x} \right).$$

$$(w) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{(x + h)^3 - x^3}{h}.$$

$$(x) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(x+h)^2} - \frac{1}{x^2}}{h}.$$

$$(y) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(2+h)^2} - \frac{1}{4}}{h}.$$

$$(z) \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(1+h)^2} - 1}{h}.$$

Solution. 14.a

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \frac{x^2 - 5x + 6}{x - 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \frac{(x - 3)(\cancel{x - 2})}{\cancel{x - 2}} \quad \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{factor and cancel} \end{array} \right. \\ &= 2 - 3 = -1 \end{aligned}$$

Solution. 14.c

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \frac{2x^2 + x - 6}{x^2 - 4} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \frac{(2x - 3)(\cancel{x + 2})}{(x - 2)(\cancel{x + 2})} \quad \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{factor and cancel} \end{array} \right. \\ &= \frac{(2(-2) - 3)}{-2 - 2} \quad \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{substitute} \end{array} \right. \\ &= \frac{7}{4} \end{aligned}$$

Solution. 14.f

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \frac{x^2 - 4}{2x^2 + 5x + 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -2} \frac{(x-2)\cancel{(x+2)}}{(2x+1)\cancel{(x+2)}} \quad \left| \text{factor and cancel} \right. \\ &= \frac{(-2) - 2}{2(-2) + 1} = \frac{4}{-3}.\end{aligned}$$

Solution. 14.g

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{x \rightarrow -1} \frac{2x^2 + 3x + 1}{3x^2 - 2x - 5} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -1} \frac{(2x+1)\cancel{(x+1)}}{(3x-5)\cancel{(x+1)}} \quad \left| \text{factor and cancel} \right. \\ &= \frac{2(-1) + 1}{3(-1) - 5} = \frac{1}{-8}.\end{aligned}$$

Solution. 14.h

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{x \rightarrow -4} \frac{x^2 + 7x + 12}{x^2 + 6x + 8} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -4} \frac{(x+3)\cancel{(x+4)}}{(x+2)\cancel{(x+4)}} \quad \left| \text{factor} \right. \\ &= \frac{-4 + 3}{-4 + 2} = -\frac{1}{2}.\end{aligned}$$

Solution. 14.x

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(x+h)^2} - \frac{1}{x^2}}{h} &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{x^2 - (x+h)^2}{hx^2(x+h)^2} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{x^2 - (x^2 + 2xh + h^2)}{hx^2(x+h)^2} \\ &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\cancel{h}(-2x+h)}{\cancel{h}x^2(x+h)^2} = \frac{-2x+0}{x^2(x+0)^2} = -\frac{2}{x^3}.\end{aligned}$$

Solution. 14.y.

Variant I.

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(2+h)^2} - \frac{1}{4}}{h} &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{4-(2+h)^2}{4(2+h)^2}}{h} \\ &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{4 - (4 + 4h + h^2)}{4h(2+h)^2} \\ &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{-4h - h^2}{4h(2+h)^2} \\ &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\cancel{h}(-4-h)}{4\cancel{h}(2+h)^2} \quad \left| \text{substitute } h = 0 \right. \\ &= \frac{-4-0}{4(2+0)^2} \\ &= -\frac{1}{4}\end{aligned}$$

Variant II.

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(2+h)^2} - \frac{1}{4}}{h} &= \frac{d}{dx} \left(\frac{1}{x^2} \right) \Big|_{x=2} \\ &= \left(\frac{-2}{x^3} \right) \Big|_{x=2} \\ &= -\frac{1}{4}\end{aligned}$$

Solution. 14.z.

Variant I.

$$\begin{aligned}
\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(1+h)^2} - 1}{h} &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1-(1+h)^2}{(1+h)^2}}{h} \\
&= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{1 - (1 + 2h + h^2)}{h(1+h)^2} \\
&= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{-2h - h^2}{h(1+h)^2} \\
&= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{h(-2-h)}{h(1+h)^2} \quad \left| \text{substitute } h = 0 \right. \\
&= \frac{-2-0}{(1+0)^2} \\
&= -2.
\end{aligned}$$

Variant II.

$$\begin{aligned}
\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{(1+h)^2} - 1}{h} &= \frac{d}{dx} \left(\frac{1}{x^2} \right) \Big|_{x=1} \quad \left| \text{derivative definition} \right. \\
&= \left(\frac{-2}{x^3} \right) \Big|_{x=1} \\
&= -2.
\end{aligned}$$

15. Find the (implied) domain of $f(x)$. Extend the definition of f at $x = 3$ to make f continuous at 3.

(a) $f(x) = \frac{x^2 - x - 6}{x - 3}.$

(b) $f(x) = \frac{x^3 - 27}{x^2 - 9}.$

with domain $x \in (-\infty, -3) \cup (-3, \infty)$
 $f(x) = \frac{x^3 - 27}{x^2 - 9} = \frac{(x-3)(x^2 + 3x + 9)}{(x-3)(x+3)} = \frac{x^2 + 3x + 9}{x+3}$
 Extend $f(x)$ to $x = 3$ to $f(3) = \frac{3^2 + 3(3) + 9}{3+3} = \frac{27}{6} = \frac{9}{2}$
 Implied domain: $x \in (-\infty, -3) \cup (-3, \infty)$
 Answer: $x \in (-\infty, -3) \cup (-3, \infty)$
 Extend $f(x)$ to $x = 3$ to $f(3) = \frac{9}{2}$
 Implied domain: $x \in (-\infty, -3) \cup (-3, \infty)$
 Answer: $x \in (-\infty, -3) \cup (-3, \infty)$

16. Use the Intermediate Value Theorem to show that there is a real number solution of the given equation in the specified interval.

(a) $x^5 + x - 3 = 0$ where $x \in (1, 2)$.

real number).

(b) $\sqrt[4]{x} = 1 - x$ where $x \in \mathbb{R}$ (i.e., x is an arbitrary real number).

(e) $\cos x = x^4$, where $x \in \mathbb{R}$ (i.e., x is an arbitrary real number).

(c) $\cos x = 2x$, where $x \in (0, 1)$.

(d) $\sin x = x^2 - x - 1$, where $x \in \mathbb{R}$ (i.e., x is an arbitrary

(f) $x^5 - x^2 + x + 3 = 0$, where $x \in \mathbb{R}$.

17.

(a) i. Solve the equation $x^2 + 13x + 41 = 1$.

ii. Use the intermediate value theorem to prove that the equation $x^2 + 13x + 41 = \sin x$ has at least two solutions, lying between the two solutions to 17.a.i.

(b) i. Solve the equation $x^2 - 15x + 55 = 1$.

ii. Use the intermediate value theorem to prove that the equation $x^2 - 15x + 55 = \cos x$ has at least two solutions, lying between the two solutions to the equation in the preceding item.

Solution. 17.a.i.

$$\begin{aligned}
x^2 + 13x + 41 &= 1 \\
x^2 + 13x + 40 &= 0 \\
(x+5)(x+8) &= 0
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore the two solutions are $x_1 = -5$ and $x_2 = -8$.

17.a.ii. Consider the function

$$f(x) = x^2 + 13x + 41 - \sin x$$

Our strategy for proving $f(x) = 0$ has a solution consists in finding a number a such that $f(a) < 0$ and a number b such that $f(b) > 0$, and then using the Intermediate Value Theorem (IVT) with $N = 0$.

Let

$$g(x) = x^2 + 13x + 41,$$

and so $f(x) = g(x) - \sin x$. We have no techniques for evaluating $\sin x$ without calculator, but we do have all knowledge necessary to evaluate $g(x)$. Indeed, from high school we know that the lowest point of the parabola $g(x)$ is located at $x = -\frac{13}{2} = -6.5$. Then $g(-6.5) = -1.25$. Therefore

$$f(-6.5) = g(-6.5) - \sin(-6.5) = g(-6.5) + \sin(6.5) = -1.25 + \sin 6.5 \leq -0.25,$$

where for the very last inequality we use the fact that $\sin 6.5 < 1$ (remember $\sin t \leq 1$ for all real values of t).

On the other hand,

$$f(-5) = g(-5) - \sin(-5) = 1 + \sin 5 > 0$$

as $\sin 5 > -1$ (remember $\sin t \geq -1$ for all real values of t). Therefore $f(-5) > 0$ and $f(-6.5) < 0$ and by the Intermediate Value Theorem (IVT) $f(x) = 0$ has a solution in the interval $x \in (-6.5, -5)$.

Proving $f(x) = 0$ has a solution in the interval $x \in (-8, -6.5)$ is similar and we leave it to the student.

Below is a computer generated plot of the function with the use of which we can visually verify our answer.

18. For which values of x is f continuous?

- $f(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } x \text{ is rational} \\ 1 & \text{if } x \text{ is irrational} \end{cases}$
- $f(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } x \text{ is rational} \\ x & \text{if } x \text{ is irrational} \end{cases}$

19. Show that $f(x)$ is continuous at all irrational points and discontinuous at all rational ones.

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{q^2} & \text{if } x \text{ is rational and } x = \frac{p}{q} \\ 0 & \text{if } x \text{ is irrational} \end{cases}$$

where in the first item p, q are relatively prime integers (i.e., integers without a common divisor).

20. Show the following limits do not exist and compute whether they evaluate to ∞ , $-\infty$, or neither.

- | | | | | | |
|--|-------------------|--|-------------------|--|-------------------|
| (a) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 3^+} \frac{x^2 + x - 1}{x^2 - 2x - 3}.$ | ANSWER: ∞ | (c) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{x^2 + 1}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2}.$ | ANSWER: ∞ | (e) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{\sqrt{x^3 - 8}}{-x^2 + x + 2}.$ | ANSWER: $-\infty$ |
| (b) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 3^-} \frac{x^2 + x - 1}{x^2 - 2x - 3}.$ | ANSWER: $-\infty$ | (d) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^-} \frac{x^2 + 1}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2}.$ | ANSWER: $-\infty$ | (f) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -1^+} \frac{\sqrt[3]{x^2 + 2x + 1}}{x^2 - 2x - 3}.$ | ANSWER: $-\infty$ |

21. Find the limit or show that it does not exist. If the limit does not exist, indicate whether it is $\pm\infty$, or neither. The answer key has not been proofread, use with caution.

- | | | | |
|---|------------------------|--|-------------------------|
| (a) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{x - 2}{2x + 1}.$ | ANSWER: $\frac{1}{2}$ | (n) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} x + \sqrt{x^2 + 3x}.$ | ANSWER: $-\frac{3}{2}$ |
| (b) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{1 - x^2}{x^3 - x - 1}.$ | ANSWER: 0 | (o) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \sqrt{x^2 + 2x} - \sqrt{x^2 - 2x}.$ | ANSWER: 2 |
| (c) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{x - 2}{x^2 + 5}.$ | ANSWER: 0 | (p) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \sqrt{x^2 + x} - \sqrt{x^2 - x}.$ | ANSWER: -1 |
| (d) $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{3x^3 + 2}{2x^3 - 4x + 5}.$ | ANSWER: $\frac{3}{2}$ | (q) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \sqrt{x^2 + ax} - \sqrt{x^2 + bx}.$ | ANSWER: $\frac{a-b}{2}$ |
| (e) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\sqrt{x} + x^2}{\sqrt{x} - x^2}.$ | ANSWER: -1 | (r) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \cos x.$ | ANSWER: DNE |
| (f) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{3 - x\sqrt{x}}{2x^{\frac{3}{2}} - 2}.$ | ANSWER: $-\frac{1}{2}$ | (s) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{x^4 + x}{x^3 - x + 2}.$ | ANSWER: ∞ |
| (g) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{(2x^2 + 3)^2}{(x - 1)^2(x^2 + 1)}.$ | ANSWER: $\frac{4}{1}$ | (t) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \sqrt{x^2 + 1}.$ | ANSWER: ∞ |
| | | (u) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} (x^4 + x^5).$ | ANSWER: $-\infty$ |
| | | (m) $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \sqrt{4x^2 + x} - 2x.$ | ANSWER: $\frac{1}{4}$ |

$$(v) \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{\sqrt{1+x^6}}{1+x^2}.$$

$$(x) \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} (x^2 - x^3).$$

$$(z) \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \sqrt{x} \sin x.$$

$$(w) \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} (x - \sqrt{x}).$$

$$(y) \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} x \sin x.$$

Solution. 21.d.

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{3x^3 + 2}{2x^3 - 4x + 5} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{(3x^3 + 2) \frac{1}{x^3}}{(2x^3 - 4x + 5) \frac{1}{x^3}} && \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Divide top} \\ \text{and bottom} \\ \text{by highest term} \\ \text{in denominator} \end{array} \right. \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{3 + \frac{2}{x^3}}{2 - \frac{4}{x^2} + \frac{5}{x^3}} \\ &= \frac{3 + 0}{2 - 0 + 0} = \frac{3}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

Solution. 21.i

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{\sqrt{x^2 + 1}}{x + 1} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{\frac{1}{x} \sqrt{x^2 + 1}}{\frac{1}{x}(x + 1)} = \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{-\frac{1}{\sqrt{x^2}} \sqrt{x^2 + 1}}{\frac{1}{x}(x + 1)} && \left| \begin{array}{l} x = -\sqrt{x^2}, \text{ whenever } x < 0 \end{array} \right. \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{-\sqrt{\frac{x^2 + 1}{x^2}}}{1 + \frac{1}{x}} = \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{-\sqrt{1 + \underbrace{\frac{1}{x^2}}_{\rightarrow 0}}}{1 + \underbrace{\frac{1}{x}}_{x \rightarrow 0}} \\ &= 1. \end{aligned}$$

Solution. 21.k.

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{\sqrt{16x^6 - 3x}}{x^3 + 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{\sqrt{x^6 \left(16 - \frac{3}{x^5}\right)}}{x^3 + 2} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{\sqrt{x^6} \sqrt{\left(16 - \frac{3}{x^5}\right)}}{x^3 + 2} && \left| \begin{array}{l} \sqrt{x^6} = -x^3 \text{ because } x < 0 \text{ as } x \rightarrow -\infty \end{array} \right. \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{-x^3 \sqrt{\left(16 - \frac{3}{x^5}\right)}}{x^3 + 2} && \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Divide by highest order term in denominator} \end{array} \right. \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{-x^3 \sqrt{\left(16 - \frac{3}{x^5}\right)}}{x^3 + 2} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{-\cancel{x^3} \sqrt{\left(16 - \frac{3}{x^5}\right)}^{\frac{1}{\cancel{x^3}}}}{(x^3 + 2) \frac{1}{x^3}} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{-\sqrt{\left(16 - \underbrace{\frac{3}{x^5}}_{\rightarrow 0}\right)}}{1 + \underbrace{\frac{2}{x^3}}_{\rightarrow 0}} \\ &= \frac{-\sqrt{16}}{1} = -4. \end{aligned}$$

Solution. 21.l

$$\begin{aligned}
\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\sqrt{3x^2 + 2x + 1}}{x + 1} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\frac{1}{x} \sqrt{3x^2 + 2x + 1}}{\frac{1}{x}(x + 1)} \\
&= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\sqrt{\frac{3x^2 + 2x + 1}{x^2}}}{\left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right)} \\
&= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\sqrt{3 + \frac{2}{x} + \frac{1}{x^2}}}{\left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right)} \\
&= \frac{\sqrt{3 + 0 + 0}}{1 + 0} \\
&= \sqrt{3}.
\end{aligned}$$

Solution. 21.p.

$$\begin{aligned}
\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \sqrt{x^2 + x} - \sqrt{x^2 - x} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \left(\sqrt{x^2 + x} - \sqrt{x^2 - x} \right) \frac{(\sqrt{x^2 + x} + \sqrt{x^2 - x})}{(\sqrt{x^2 + x} + \sqrt{x^2 - x})} \\
&= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{x^2 + x - (x^2 - x)}{\sqrt{x^2 + x} + \sqrt{x^2 - x}} = \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2x}{\sqrt{x^2 + x} + \sqrt{x^2 - x}} \cdot \frac{1}{x} \\
&= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{\frac{2}{x}}{\frac{\sqrt{x^2 + x}}{x} + \frac{\sqrt{x^2 - x}}{x}} = \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2}{-\sqrt{1 + \frac{1}{x}} - \sqrt{1 - \frac{1}{x}}} \\
&= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2}{-\sqrt{1 + 0} - \sqrt{1 - 0}} = -1.
\end{aligned}$$

The sign highlighted in red arises from the fact that, for negative x , we have that $x = -\sqrt{x^2}$.

22. Find the horizontal and vertical asymptotes of the graph of the function. If a graphing device is available, check your work by plotting the function.

(a) $y = \frac{2x}{\sqrt{x^2 + x + 3} - 3}.$

answer: vertical: $x = -1$, $x = 3$, horizontal: $y = -5$

(b) $y = \frac{3x^2}{\sqrt{x^2 + 2x + 10} - 5}.$

answer: Vertical: $x = 3$, $x = -2$, horizontal: none.

(c) $y = \frac{3x + 1}{x - 2}.$

answer: vertical: $x = 2$, horizontal: $y = 3$

(d) $y = \frac{x^2 - 1}{2x^2 - 3x - 2}.$

answer: vertical: $x = 2$, $x = -\frac{1}{2}$, horizontal: $y = \frac{5}{4}$

(e) $y = \frac{2x^2 - 2x - 1}{x^2 + x - 2}.$

answer: vertical: $x = 1$, $x = -2$, horizontal: $y = 2$

(f) $f(x) = \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{x^2 - 2x - 3}$

(g) $y = \frac{1 + x^4}{x^2 - x^4}.$

answer: vertical: $x = 0$, $x = 1$, $x = -1$, horizontal: $y = -1$

(h) $y = \frac{x^3 - x}{x^2 - 7x + 6}.$

answer: vertical: $x = 6$, no horizontal asymptote

(i) $y = \frac{x - 9}{\sqrt{4x^2 + 3x + 3}}.$

answer: no vertical asymptote, horizontal: $y = \pm \frac{3}{4}$

(j) $y = \frac{\sqrt{x^2 + 1} - x}{x}.$

answer: vertical: $x = 0$, horizontal: $y = 0$, $y = -2$

(k) $f(x) = \frac{x}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2x}$

answer: vertical: $x = 1$, horizontal: $y = -\frac{3}{4}$, $y = -1$

Solution. 22.a **Vertical asymptotes.** A function $f(x)$ has a vertical asymptote at $x = a$ if $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = \pm\infty$.

The function is algebraic, and therefore has a finite limit at every point it is defined (i.e., no asymptote). Therefore the function can have vertical asymptotes only for those x for which $f(x)$ is not defined. The function is not defined for $\sqrt{x^2 + x + 3} - 3 = 0$, which has two solutions, $x = 2$ and $x = -3$. These are precisely the vertical asymptotes: indeed,

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{2x}{\sqrt{x^2 + x + 3} - 3} = \infty \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{2x}{\sqrt{x^2 + x + 3} - 3} = -\infty$$

and

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow -3^+} \frac{2x}{\sqrt{x^2 + x + 3} - 3} = \infty \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow -3^-} \frac{2x}{\sqrt{x^2 + x + 3} - 3} = -\infty$$

Horizontal asymptotes. A function $f(x)$ has a horizontal asymptote if $\lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} f(x)$ exists. If that limit exists, and is some number, say, N , then $y = N$ is the equation of the corresponding asymptote.

Consider the limit $x \rightarrow -\infty$. We have that

$$\begin{aligned}
 \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2x}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3x + 3} - 3} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2}{\frac{\sqrt{x^2 + 3x + 3}}{x} - \frac{3}{x}} \\
 &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2}{-\sqrt{\frac{x^2 + 3x + 3}{x^2}} - \frac{3}{x}} \quad \left| \frac{1}{x} = -\sqrt{\frac{1}{x^2}} \text{ when } x < 0 \right. \\
 &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2}{-\sqrt{1 + \frac{3}{x} + \frac{3}{x^2}} - \frac{3}{x}} \\
 &= \frac{\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} 2}{-\sqrt{\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} 1 + \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{3}{x} + \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{3}{x^2}} - \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{3}{x}} \\
 &= \frac{2}{-\sqrt{1 + 0 + 0} - 0} \\
 &= -2.
 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore $y = -2$ is a horizontal asymptote.

The case $x \rightarrow \infty$, is handled similarly and yields that $y = 2$ is a horizontal asymptote.

A computer generated graph confirms our computations.

Solution. 22.d

Vertical asymptotes. A function $f(x)$ has a vertical asymptote at $x = a$ if $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = \pm\infty$.

The function is algebraic, and therefore has a finite limit at every point it is defined (i.e., no asymptote). Therefore the function can have vertical asymptotes only for those x for which $f(x)$ is not defined. The function is not defined for $2x^2 - 3x - 2 = 0$, which has two solutions, $x = 2$ and $x = -\frac{1}{2}$. These are precisely the vertical asymptotes: indeed,

$$\begin{aligned}
 \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2x^2 - 3x - 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^+} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2(x - 2)(x + \frac{1}{2})} = \infty & \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Limit of form } \frac{(+)}{(+)(+)} \\ \text{Limit of form } \frac{(+)}{(-)(+)} \end{array} \right. \\
 \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2x^2 - 3x - 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 2^-} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2(x - 2)(x + \frac{1}{2})} = -\infty
 \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned}
 \lim_{x \rightarrow -\frac{1}{2}^+} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2x^2 - 3x - 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\frac{1}{2}^+} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2(x - 2)(x + \frac{1}{2})} = \infty & \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Limit of form } \frac{(-)}{(+)(-)} \\ \text{Limit of form } \frac{(-)}{(-)(-)} \end{array} \right. \\
 \lim_{x \rightarrow -\frac{1}{2}^-} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2x^2 - 3x - 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\frac{1}{2}^-} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2(x - 2)(x + \frac{1}{2})} = -\infty
 \end{aligned}$$

Horizontal asymptotes. A function $f(x)$ has a horizontal asymptote if $\lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} f(x)$ exists. If that limit exists, and is some number, say, N , then $y = N$ is the equation of the corresponding asymptote.

We have that

$$\begin{aligned}
 \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2x^2 - 3x - 2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{(x^2 - 1) \frac{1}{x^2}}{(2x^2 - 3x - 2) \frac{1}{x^2}} & \left| \text{Divide by highest term in den.} \right. \\
 &= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1 - \frac{1}{x^2}}{2 - \frac{3}{x} - \frac{2}{x^2}} \\
 &= \frac{\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} 1 - \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{x^2}}{\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} 2 - \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{3}{x} - \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{2}{x^2}} & \left| \text{Step may be skipped} \right. \\
 &= \frac{1 - 0}{2 - 0 - 0} \\
 &= \frac{1}{2}
 \end{aligned}$$

A similar computation shows that

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{x^2 - 1}{2x^2 - 3x - 2} = \frac{1}{2}$$

Therefore $y = \frac{1}{2}$ is the only horizontal asymptote, valid in both directions ($x \rightarrow \pm\infty$).

A computer generated graph confirms our computations.

Solution. 22.f

Vertical asymptotes. The function is rational, and therefore has a finite limit (and therefore no vertical asymptote) at every point in its domain. The function is not defined for $x^2 - 2x - 3 = 0$, which has two solutions, $x = -1$ and $x = 3$. These are precisely the vertical asymptotes: indeed,

$$\begin{array}{lcl} \lim_{x \rightarrow -1^+} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{x^2 - 2x - 3} = \lim_{x \rightarrow -1^+} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{(x+1)(x-3)} = -\infty & \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Limit of form } \frac{(+)}{(+)(-)} \\ \text{Limit of form } \frac{(+)}{(-)(-)} \end{array} \right. \\ \lim_{x \rightarrow -1^-} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{x^2 - 2x - 3} = \lim_{x \rightarrow -1^-} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{(x+1)(x-3)} = \infty \end{array}$$

and

$$\begin{array}{lcl} \lim_{x \rightarrow 3^+} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{x^2 - 2x - 3} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 3^+} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{(x+1)(x-3)} = -\infty & \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Limit of form } \frac{(-)}{(+)(+)} \\ \text{Limit of form } \frac{(-)}{(+)(-)} \end{array} \right. \\ \lim_{x \rightarrow 3^-} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{x^2 - 2x - 3} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 3^-} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{(x+1)(x-3)} = \infty \end{array}$$

Horizontal asymptotes.

$$\begin{array}{lcl} \lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} \frac{-5x^2 - 3x + 5}{x^2 - 2x - 3} = \lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} \frac{(-5x^2 - 3x + 5) \frac{1}{x^2}}{(x^2 - 2x - 3) \frac{1}{x^2}} & \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Divide by highest term in den.} \end{array} \right. \\ = \lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} \frac{-5 - \frac{3}{x} + \frac{5}{x^2}}{1 - \frac{2}{x} - \frac{3}{x^2}} & & \\ = \frac{-\lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} 5 - \lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} \frac{3}{x} + \lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} \frac{5}{x^2}}{\lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} 1 - \lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} \frac{2}{x} - \lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} \frac{3}{x^2}} & \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{Step may be skipped} \end{array} \right. \\ = \frac{-5 - 0 + 0}{1 - 0 - 0} \\ = -5. \end{array}$$

Therefore $y = -5$ is the only horizontal asymptote, valid in both directions ($x \rightarrow \pm\infty$).

A computer generated graph confirms our computations.

Solution. 22.k

Vertical asymptotes. A function $f(x)$ has a vertical asymptote at $x = a$ if $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = \pm\infty$.

The function is algebraic, and therefore has a finite limit at every point it is defined (i.e., no asymptote). Therefore the function can have vertical asymptotes only for those x for which $f(x)$ is not defined. The function is not defined for

$$\begin{array}{lcl} \sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2x = 0 & & \\ \sqrt{x^2 + 3} = 2x & \left| \begin{array}{l} \text{square both sides} \\ \text{may introduce extraneous solutions} \end{array} \right. & \\ x^2 + 3 = 4x^2 & & \\ 3x^2 - 3 = 0 & & \\ 3(x-1)(x+1) = 0 & & \\ x = 1 \text{ or } x = -1 & & \\ x = -1 \text{ is extraneous:} & & \\ \sqrt{(-1)^2 + 3} - (-1)2 = 4 \neq 0 & & \end{array}$$

$x = -1$ is indeed a vertical asymptote:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{x}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2x} = \infty \qquad \lim_{x \rightarrow 1^-} \frac{x}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2x} = -\infty.$$

Horizontal asymptotes.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{x}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2x} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{1}{\frac{\sqrt{x^2 + 3}}{x} - 2} \\
 &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{1}{-\sqrt{\frac{x^2 + 3}{x^2}} - 2} \quad \left| \frac{1}{x} = -\sqrt{\frac{1}{x^2}} \text{ when } x < 0 \right. \\
 &= \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{1}{-\sqrt{1 + \frac{3}{x^2}} - 2} \\
 &= \frac{1}{-\sqrt{1 + 0} - 2} \\
 &= -\frac{1}{3}. \\
 \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{x}{\sqrt{x^2 + 3} - 2x} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{\frac{\sqrt{x^2 + 3}}{x} - 2} \\
 &= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{\frac{x^2 + 3}{x^2}} - 2} \quad \left| \frac{1}{x} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{x^2}} \text{ when } x > 0 \right. \\
 &= \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + \frac{3}{x^2}} - 2} \\
 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + 0} - 2} \\
 &= -1.
 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore $y = -\frac{1}{3}$ and $y = -1$ are the two horizontal asymptotes.

A computer generated graph confirms our computations.